

Interviewees:

Mr. S. K. Ahmed Raza

Role: Founder & CEO, Heal Cancer Support

Experience: Healthcare entrepreneur with a background in Pharmacy and MBA | **Industry:** Healthcare Technology, AI & Social Entrepreneurship

Dr. Noopur Gupta

Role: Co-Founder & Cancer Researcher, Heal Cancer Support

Experience: Cancer researcher specializing in oncology and rural healthcare | **Industry:** Healthcare Research & Clinical Innovation

1. Key Questions and Discussion Points

- **Identifying the Real Problem:** The discussion focused on how the founders recognized that the major challenge was not the lack of cancer treatment but poor access, awareness, and navigation for rural patients.
- **Decision-Making Under Uncertainty:** The interview explored how important decisions are made in a startup using research, field validation, and rapid experimentation despite limited resources.
- **Collaboration and Stakeholder Involvement:** The participants explained how founders, clinicians, and team members jointly contribute to important decisions through collaborative discussions.
- **Learning Through Continuous Improvement:** The conversation highlighted how failed ideas are treated as learning opportunities, encouraging continuous refinement of products and strategies.

2. Key Insights

- **Recognizing Root Causes:** Successful decisions begin by understanding the real problem rather than its symptoms. The team focused on improving healthcare accessibility instead of developing new treatments.
- **Evidence-Based Decision-Making:** Decisions are supported by academic research, expert advice, and direct field interactions with patients and rural communities.
- **Collaborative Leadership:** The founders value diverse opinions and involve team members in decision-making to improve solution quality.
- **Adaptive Decision-Making:** They continuously test, learn, and refine their strategies, viewing unsuccessful attempts as opportunities for improvement.

3. Relevant Quotes

- **On Identifying the Real Problem:**
"Treatment is available... The only thing is people are not able to access them. They don't know how to access the services." — Dr. Noopur Gupta
- **On Evidence-Based Decisions:**
"We are researching from the papers... and we are directly going to the ground." — S. K. Ahmed Raza
- **On Collaborative Decision-Making:**
"First I ask them... then definitely after collaborative discussion we go to do that part." — S. K. Ahmed Raza
- **On Learning from Failure:**
"Some didn't work... we are learning and we are redefining." — S. K. Ahmed Raza
- **On Validating Real Needs:**
"First you have to see... where is the need for that idea or that business." — S. K. Ahmed Raza

Interviewee: Yashvi Pandey

Role: Chartered Accountant & Credit Underwriter

Experience: Chartered Accountant working in the banking sector with responsibilities in credit underwriting and business loan approvals.

Industry: Banking, Finance & Risk Management

1. Key Questions and Discussion Points

- **Decision-Making Under Uncertainty:** The discussion explored how professionals respond when unexpected situations disrupt carefully planned career paths, using Yashvi's experience of an unexpected role change after joining a new organization.
- **Balancing Data, Experience, and Intuition:** The interview focused on how financial decisions are made by combining quantitative analysis, professional experience, customer interactions, and intuition rather than relying solely on data.
- **Managing Emotions and External Influence:** The conversation highlighted the importance of avoiding impulsive decisions, understanding one's emotions, resisting peer pressure, and maintaining clarity about long-term goals.
- **Ethics and Professional Responsibility:** The discussion emphasized that ethical decision-making is fundamental in finance, where every decision carries responsibility toward customers, institutions, and public trust.

2. Key Insights

- **Clarity Drives Better Decisions:** Effective decision-making begins with having a clear understanding of long-term personal and professional goals before evaluating available options.
- **Balanced Judgment Improves Decision Quality:** Successful decisions require integrating data, professional experience, stakeholder discussions, and intuition rather than depending on a single source of information.
- **Self-Awareness Reduces Decision Errors:** Understanding emotions, personal biases, and behavioral patterns helps professionals avoid making poor decisions during stressful situations.
- **Ethical Values Sustain Long-Term Success:** Professionals must prioritize integrity and responsibility, even when shortcuts or personal benefits are available.

3. Relevant Quotes

- **On Long-Term Clarity:**
"You should have that clarity of what you want and where you want to go in life."
- **On Independent Decision-Making:**
"You should not get influenced by other people. Understand your situation and what you want in life."
- **On Data, Experience and Intuition:**
"You have to analyze everything... check the data, use your experience and your gut feeling as well."
- **On AI and Human Judgment:**
"AI has all the data, but it doesn't have emotional intelligence."
- **On Managing Emotions:**
"Maybe this is not the right time to make this decision. I can postpone it to the next morning."
- **On Decision-Making Framework:**
"Understand what you want, analyze the data, and understand how this decision is going to affect you in the next 5–10 years."

Interviewee: Mr. Pradeep Jha

Role: Former Indian Engineering Services (IES) Officer & Former Chief Engineer, SGPGIMS Lucknow

Experience: B.Tech (Civil Engineering), IIT Kanpur (1978) | Over 40 years of experience

Industry: Civil Engineering, Infrastructure Development & Project Management

1. Key Questions and Discussion Points

- **Recognizing Engineering Problems:** The discussion focused on how experienced engineers identify potential issues through detailed design reviews, interdisciplinary coordination, and careful examination of technical specifications before execution.
- **Decision-Making with Incomplete Information:** The interview explored how engineering decisions are made despite uncertainty by understanding project dependencies and acting when sufficient information for a particular stage is available.
- **Risk Assessment and Safety:** The conversation highlighted the importance of following engineering codes, balancing safety, cost, quality, and project timelines, and using experience to evaluate technical trade-offs.
- **Stakeholder Communication and Leadership:** Mr. Jha explained how consultants, contractors, engineers, and clients are involved in the decision-making process through open discussions, clear communication, and constructive feedback.

2. Key Insights

- **Thorough preparation reduces future problems.** Careful study of engineering drawings and coordination among different disciplines helps prevent costly mistakes during project execution.
- **Timely decisions are more important than waiting for perfect information.** Engineering projects progress sequentially, requiring decisions based on adequate rather than complete information.
- **Safety is the highest priority.** Compliance with engineering codes and standards should never be compromised while balancing cost, quality, and project schedules.
- **Effective leadership requires communication and adaptability.** Listening to stakeholders, considering expert opinions, and being willing to revise decisions improve project outcomes.
- **Delegation must be accompanied by verification.** Leaders should assign responsibilities based on capability while ensuring adequate supervision and accountability.

3. Relevant Quotes

On Problem Recognition:

"The insight regarding likely problems comes from thorough study of the designs and coordination among different engineering disciplines."

On Decision-Making Under Uncertainty:

"It is not important to have all the information most of the time. Projects are mostly sequential events."

On Risk and Safety:

"On safety, rely on codes of practice and ensure these are followed scrupulously."

On Leadership and Communication:

"Be nimble, listen, and where necessary, give good reasons to reject. Accept and change where a person is right."

On Professional Learning:

"God is in the details. Delegate, but be clear about capabilities, sincerity, and your capacity to evaluate correctly."

Interviewee: Fr. Nobit B.K.

Role: Principal, St. Francis De Sales Sr. Sec. School

Experience: Over 5 years as Principal with extensive experience in educational leadership.

Industry/Domain: Education & School Administration

1. Key Questions and Discussion Points

- **Decision-Making in Educational Leadership:** The discussion explored how school leaders make decisions while balancing academics, administration, student welfare, and institutional policies under uncertain situations.
- **Evidence-Based Problem Solving:** The interview highlighted the importance of collecting facts from multiple sources, including teachers, students, parents, CCTV footage, and institutional records before making disciplinary decisions.
- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** The conversation focused on involving teachers, parents, committees, and management while making major institutional decisions to ensure fairness and long-term acceptance.
- **Learning from Failure and Adaptation:** The discussion examined how unsuccessful initiatives, such as introducing a new playgroup program, provided valuable lessons for future decision-making.

2. Key Insights

- **Gather Complete Information Before Acting:** Effective leaders avoid making judgments based on a single perspective and instead collect evidence from multiple stakeholders before taking action.
- **Evidence Improves Decision Quality:** Decisions become more reliable when supported by objective evidence, institutional policies, and factual verification rather than assumptions or emotions.
- **Stakeholder Consultation Builds Better Decisions:** Consulting teachers, parents, and committees helps leaders refine decisions and gain broader acceptance.
- **Adaptability is Essential for Leadership:** Not every decision succeeds, but leaders must learn from unsuccessful outcomes, adapt to changing environments, and continuously improve.

3. Relevant Quotes

- **On Gathering Complete Information:**
"I don't go with one person's opinion. I call both the teams and find out what has really happened."
- **On Evidence-Based Decisions:**
"First we collect the evidence... after showing the CCTV footage, the parents understood the reason behind the decision."
- **On Timely Decision-Making:**
"It is not necessary to take immediate actions. Sometimes immediate action can go wrong."
- **On Decision Philosophy:**
"There is no right decision. Take a decision and make it right."
- **On Learning from Failure:**
"The decision to start the playgroup did not work out... we need adaptability."
- **On Advice to Students:**
"There is nothing that comes by luck. We need to work hard for whatever we are doing."

Interviewee: G. Mouni Sreedhar

Designation: General Manager, District Industries Centre (DIC), Government of Andhra Pradesh

Domain: Public Administration & Industrial Development

Education: M.Tech (M.E.), IIT Madras

1. Key Questions and Discussion Points

- **Decision-Making Under Regulatory Uncertainty:** The interview explored how government officers make legally sound decisions when responsibility is unclear, using an industrial accident case where legal liability and moral responsibility differed.
- **Balancing Speed and Compliance:** The discussion highlighted how investment projects are approved by balancing regulatory compliance with the need to avoid unnecessary delays in industrial development.
- **Experience in Administrative Decisions:** The conversation emphasized how professional experience, intuition, and public interest guide decisions alongside established government rules and procedures.
- **Leadership in a Changing Environment:** The interview concluded by discussing the importance of adapting to technological reforms, digital governance, and avoiding impulsive decisions under pressure.

2. Key Insights

- **Legal Decisions Must Follow Accountability:** Even when circumstances appear unfair, public administrators must act according to legal responsibility while ensuring justice and compensation.
- **Balanced Risk Enables Progress:** Conditional approvals and continuous monitoring allow projects to move forward without compromising regulatory compliance.
- **Experience Strengthens Decision Quality:** Practical experience helps leaders assess project viability, public benefit, and long-term impact beyond written procedures.
- **Adaptability and Patience Improve Leadership:** Successful public servants embrace technological change, monitor long-term consequences, and avoid making hurried decisions during stressful situations.

3. Relevant Quotes

- **On Conditional Decision-Making:**
"We take self-declarations and give conditional approvals so that the project is not delayed."
- **On Experience:**
"Most of the decision making comes by experience only."
- **On Judgement:**
"By experience and by gauging the situation we generally know whether the project is viable or not."
- **On Adaptability:**
"The first thing is to be adaptive to changing times."
- **On Decision-Making Under Pressure:**
"Under pressure, no hasty decisions should be taken. It is better to wait than to take a wrong decision."
- **On Long-Term Thinking:**
"We have to think about the consequences before taking any decision."